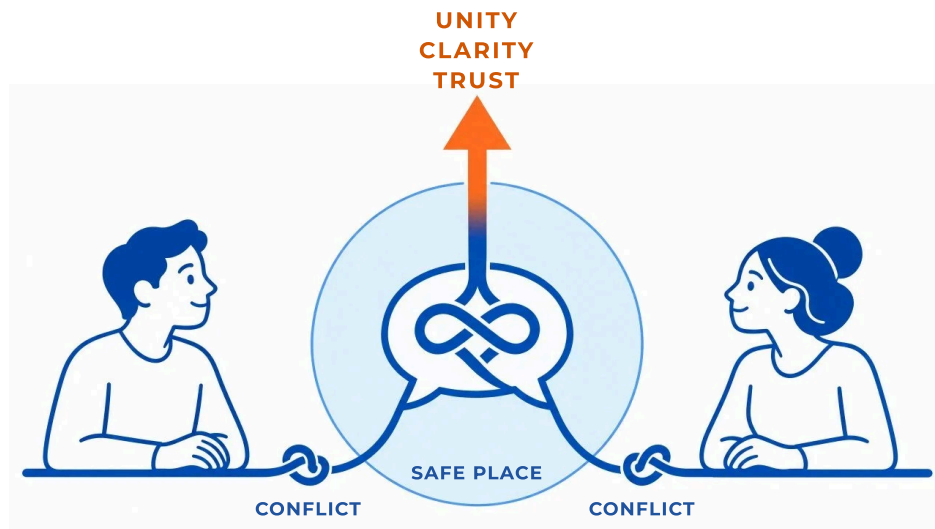




Healthy Conflict

Conflict that is not named does not go away. It grows.



Two lines come together in a safe place and go forward as one.

Five rules that create a safe place

The leader creates a safe place by explaining these rules before the conversation starts. Every person in the conversation agrees to them.

- 1 **Trust is a decision, not a feeling.**
Come to the conversation ready to trust. You may not feel trust at this moment, and that is all right. You decide to trust the other person anyway. You do this because you want to move forward with this person. Where trust is low, people hear a disagreement about the work as a personal attack. Choosing to trust keeps the conversation about the problem.
- 2 **There is no winner and no loser.**
The goal is not to win the argument. The goal is a better result for the team. If one person loses, the whole team loses something.
- 3 **Talk about the problem, not the person.**
Describe what happened and how it affects the work. Do not describe the other person's character. People can solve a problem together. A judgement about a person can only be defended.
- 4 **Listen until you can repeat the other person's view.**
Before you answer, say back what you heard. Keep going until the other person agrees that you understood. You do not have to agree with them. You do have to understand them first.
- 5 **Talk first, then adjust.**
Do not quietly change your behaviour to get around the problem. Adjusting in silence is a form of avoiding. Talk first. Then both people adjust, based on what you agreed together.

These rules are for differences between people who work together. They do not cover abuse, harassment, misconduct or safeguarding concerns. Those must be reported to the right person, not talked through as a conflict.